



University of Houston (UH) APEX Accelerator

Your Government Contracting & Procurement Excellence Team

Federal, State of Texas, and Local Government Socioeconomic Certification Programs

<u>Certifying Agency / Certification Program</u>	<u>Federal (SBA)</u> 8(a)	<u>Federal (SBA)</u> HUBZone (HZ)	<u>Federal (SBA)</u> Women-Owned Small Business-SB (WOSB) & Economically Disadvantaged Women-Owned SB (EDWOSB)	<u>Federal (SBA)</u> Veteran-Owned Small Business (VOSB) & Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business (SDVOSB);	<u>State of TX</u> Veteran Heroes United in Business (VetHUB)
<u>Program Website</u> (incs. benefits of and reference to applicable implementing statutes, rules & regulations and goals)	https://www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/8a-business-development-program	https://www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/hubzone-program	https://www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/women-owned-small-business-federal-contract-program	https://www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/veteran-contracting-assistance-programs	https://comptroller.texas.gov/purchasing/vendor/hub/
<u>Group Participation</u>	Must provide a SDN-Social Disadvantage Narrative to determine eligibility	<u>Principal Office located in a SBA Designated HUBZone:</u>	Women and Economically Disadvantaged Women (<u>Business must be owned and controlled by one or more women</u>)	Veterans and Service Disabled Veterans	"A state of Texas Veteran Heroes United in Business Historically Underutilized Business (HUB) Certification requires at least 51 percent of the business be owned, managed, and operated by owner(s) who meet the qualified requirement as a service-disabled-veteran (SDV) (with at least a 20 percent service disability as identified by the federal military department). The business must be primarily based in Texas. The business must also meet the Small Business Administration (SBA) size standards set forth in the business categories of 13 CFR.
<u>Economic Disadvantage Criteria, e.g., Assets, Personal Income, & PNW-Personal Net Worth</u>	*PNW of \$850K or less, *AGI-Adjusted Gross Income of \$400K or less, & *Assets totaling \$6.5 million or less	N/A	*PNW of \$850K or less, *AGI-Adjusted Gross Income of \$400K or less, & *Assets totaling \$6.5 million or less	N/A	N/A
<u>Citizenship / Residency</u>	U.S. Citizen	U.S. Citizen	U.S. Citizen	U.S. Residency	Texas Residency
<u>Other Notable Qualification Requirements (Not All-Inclusive)</u>	Evidence potential for success, e.g., 2-year Rule per 13 CFR 124.107 Plus, other eligibility criteria	Have <u>at least 35%</u> of business' employees living in a HUBZone. "Employee" is defined per 13 CFR 126.103	Not all NAICS Codes are eligible for the Program. Visit this website for a list of all Eligible NAICS Codes for both WOSB and EDWOSB.	Be identified by the VA as a Veteran or Service-Disabled Veteran.	"The applicant/owner must: * Provide proof of 51 percent ownership and control of the day to day operation of the business. * Be an Economically disadvantaged person meet eligibility as a: > Service-Disabled Veteran with a service-related disability of 20% or greater. The applicant/owner must: * Prove control of the day to day operations, and * Hold company title equivalent to ownership and control requirements. The applicant business must: * Be primarily based in Texas, * Prove its principal place of business is in Texas, and * Be a for-profit entity that has not exceeded the size standard prescribed by 34 TAC §20.294 " "Please allow up to 90 days for review of VetHUB Certification applications. Processing time can take longer when applications are incomplete."
<u>Average Processing Time After Receipt of Complete Application (varies per agency workload)</u>	Varies: 4 - 8+ Months	100 Days	WOSB = 75 days EDWOSB = 117 Days	75 Days	"Please allow up to 90 days for review of VetHUB Certification applications. Processing time can take longer when applications are incomplete."
<u>Certification Term</u>	9 Years maximum (Requires Annual Review)	Every five years the HZ Program is required to update the HUBZone designations to ensure the Program continues to serve the communities that are most in need of assistance. Most areas stay the same but some change.	Annual attestation of meeting Program requirements. Additionally, firms must undergo a Program examination every three years conducted by SBA or a third-party certifier.	Valid for three years from the approval date.	Good for up to four years, provided that the business continues to meet the eligibility requirements.
<u>Application Website</u>	https://certifications.sba.gov/	https://certifications.sba.gov/	https://certifications.sba.gov/	https://certifications.sba.gov/	https://texashub.gob2g.com/

Contact Information: UH APEX Accelerator 713-752-8477 www.uhapex.uh.edu



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<u>Certifying Agency / Certification Program</u>	METRO Small Business Enterprise (SBE)	<u>Texas Unified Certification Program</u> Disadvantaged Business Enterprise (DBE) & Airport Concessions DBE (ACDBE)	<u>City of Houston (COH)</u> Minority / Women / Persons w/Disabilities / Small Business / Enterprise - M/W/PD/S/BE	<u>City of Houston (COH)</u> Section 3	<u>Women’s Business Enterprise National</u> <u>Council (WBENC)</u> <u>Women Business Enterprise Alliance (WBEA)</u>
<u>Program Website</u> (incs. benefits of and reference to applicable implementing statutes, rules & regulations and goals)	https://www.ridemetro.org/about/business-to-business/procurement-opportunities/small-business-dbe-programs	https://www.txdot.gov/business/disadvantaged-small-business-enterprise/dbe-airport-concessions.html	https://www.houstontx.gov/obo/certification_overview.html	https://houstontx.gov/housing/compliance/section3/index.html#section3	https://www.wbenc.org/certification/
<u>Group Participation</u>	SB-Small Business IAW SBA's Size Standards	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	Minority, Women, Persons with Disabilities, Small Business Enterprise (SBE is for Construction and Construction-Related Businesses Only)	*51% owned and controlled by low-income person(s); or *75% of business labor hours are performed by low-income persons; or *51% owned and controlled by current public housing residents or residents who currently live in Section 8 assisted housing	Women
<u>Economic Disadvantage Criteria, e.g., Assets, Personal Income, & PNW-Personal Net Worth</u>	1. Has been in operation at least one year 2. Has at least one year of business tax returns 3. Has at least \$5,000 in revenue in the last 12 months 4. Does not exceed the SBA's Size Standards 5. Does not exceed \$2.047M personal net worth for each owner with 5% or more	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	<u>Basic Requirements:</u>	A Section 3 Worker is any individual who currently fits, or when hired within the past five (5) years fits, at least one of the following categories: *The worker’s income for the previous or current calendar year is below HUD income limits ; or *The worker is employed by a Section 3 Business Concern; or *The worker is a YouthBuild participant.	<u>Processing Fee:</u>
<u>Citizenship / Residency</u>	U.S. Citizen or Lawfully Admitted Permanent Resident Maintain a significant local business presence in the Houston region.	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	U.S. Citizen or Lawfully Admitted Permanent Resident. The business must maintain a significant and local presence in Harris, Austin, Brazoria, Chambers, Fort Bend, Galveston, Liberty, Montgomery, San Jacinto, or Waller County.	Citizenship - N/A	U.S. Citizen or U.S. Resident Alien status.
<u>Other Notable Qualification Requirements (Not All-Inclusive)</u>	Certified DBE firms are recognized as SBEs without having to submit an SBE application	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	In business for 6 months prior to application date or company invoice and proof of payment if business is less than 6 months old.	See link above	Business must meet the following criteria: * Majority (at least 51%) ownership by one or more women * Demonstrated proof of female management and control of business * Unrestricted female control of the business in legal documents and day-to-day operations * A woman holding the highest defined title in the company’s legal documents * Documented evidence of female contribution of capital and/or industry expertise
<u>Average Processing Time After Receipt of Complete Application (varies per agency workload)</u>	30 - 60 days	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	7 to 14 days once application requirements are met	60 - 90 Days
<u>Certification Term</u>	Three Years from date of issuance	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	Three Calendar Years	1–3 years (varies) / <u>Note:</u> A business retains Section 3 Business Concern status as long as it continues to meet the qualifying definition (ownership, workforce, or labor-hour criteria).	Recertify Every Year
<u>Application Website</u>	https://ridemetro.sdbbe.com/	"All DBE certification-related activities are halted until further notice."	https://houston.mwdbe.com/?TN=houston	https://hcddsection3.gob2g.com/	https://www.wbenc.org/certification/

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